

ANGER MANAGEMENT WORKBOOK FOR TEENS

Cool Down Before You Blow Up

A Practical Guide for Teenagers
to Understand and Manage Anger

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WHAT IS ANGER? (Real Talk)

Let's be honest: everyone gets angry. Your parents, your teachers, your friends - literally everyone. Anger is a NORMAL emotion. It's not bad or wrong to feel angry. The problem only starts when anger makes you do things you regret.

WHY DO TEENS GET SO ANGRY?

- Your brain is literally under construction (prefrontal cortex developing)
- Hormones are all over the place
- You're dealing with more social pressure than ever
- You want independence but still have rules to follow
- School stress, friend drama, family issues - it's a LOT

ANGER IS A SECONDARY EMOTION

Under anger, there's usually something else:

- Feeling disrespected or embarrassed
- Feeling hurt or rejected
- Feeling scared or anxious
- Feeling powerless or unheard
- Feeling overwhelmed

THIS WORKBOOK WILL HELP YOU:

- Understand YOUR anger (everyone's is different)
- Catch it before it explodes
- Handle it without making things worse
- Communicate what you actually need
- Stop the guilt/shame cycle after blowups

You're not broken. You just need better tools.

MY ANGER TRIGGERS

What sets YOU off? Be specific. Circle the ones that hit hardest:

- ☐ Being told what to do / micromanaged
- ☐ Getting embarrassed in front of others
- ☐ Someone touching my stuff
- ☐ Being accused of something I didn't do
- ☐ People talking behind my back
- ☐ Feeling left out or excluded
- ☐ Parents comparing me to siblings
- ☐ Teachers being unfair
- ☐ Someone breaking a promise
- ☐ Losing at something important to me
- ☐ Being interrupted or ignored
- ☐ Someone disrespecting my friends/family
- ☐ Not getting enough sleep
- ☐ Being hungry (hangry is real)
- ☐ Social media drama
- ☐ Feeling misunderstood

MY TOP 5 PERSONAL TRIGGERS:

1. _____
How often (daily/weekly/rarely): _____ Intensity 1-10: ____
2. _____
How often (daily/weekly/rarely): _____ Intensity 1-10: ____
3. _____
How often (daily/weekly/rarely): _____ Intensity 1-10: ____
4. _____
How often (daily/weekly/rarely): _____ Intensity 1-10: ____
5. _____
How often (daily/weekly/rarely): _____ Intensity 1-10: ____

PHYSICAL WARNING SIGNS

Your body talks before you explode

Check the warning signs YOUR body gives you:

HEAD:

- ☐ Headache
- ☐ Seeing red/tunnel vision
- ☐ Can't think straight
- ☐ Racing thoughts

FACE/NECK:

- ☐ Jaw clenching
- ☐ Face gets hot/red
- ☐ Neck tension
- ☐ Teeth grinding

CHEST:

- ☐ Heart pounding
- ☐ Chest tight
- ☐ Breathing fast
- ☐ Feel like screaming

STOMACH:

- ☐ Stomach in knots
- ☐ Nausea
- ☐ Appetite disappears
- ☐ Butterflies

HANDS/ARMS:

- ☐ Fists clenching
- ☐ Shaking
- ☐ Want to hit something
- ☐ Gripping things hard

LEGS/FEET:

- ☐ Pacing
- ☐ Leg bouncing
- ☐ Want to run
- ☐ Stomping

My FIRST warning sign (the earliest one I notice):

THE VOLCANO MODEL

Anger has levels - know where you are

LEVEL 5 - ERUPTION (10/10)

Full explosion. Yelling, breaking things, saying horrible things.

You can't think. Adrenaline has taken over completely.

RECOVERY TIME: 30-60 minutes minimum

LEVEL 4 - ABOUT TO BLOW (7-9/10)

Shouting, aggressive body language, threatening.

Still a tiny bit of control. THIS IS YOUR LAST CHANCE to use tools.

BEST MOVE: Walk away NOW. No discussion. Just leave safely.

LEVEL 3 - HEATING UP (5-6/10)

Arguing, raised voice, sarcasm, door slamming.

You can still think but it's getting harder.

BEST MOVE: Use a cool-down strategy. Tell them you need a minute.

LEVEL 2 - WARMING (3-4/10)

Irritated, annoyed, eye-rolling, short responses.

You can still make good choices easily here.

BEST MOVE: Name it. 'I'm getting frustrated.' Use a strategy.

LEVEL 1 - CALM (1-2/10)

Chill, relaxed, can handle things that come up.

This is where you build skills and make plans.

BEST MOVE: Practice your strategies so they're automatic.

Right now I'm usually at Level ____ when I start my strategies.

I want to start catching myself at Level ____.

COOL-DOWN STRATEGIES MENU

Pick 5 favorites and practice them when calm

1. Box breathing (4 in, 4 hold, 4 out, 4 hold)
2. Squeeze an ice cube in your hand (pain redirect)
3. Sprint or do jumping jacks for 60 seconds
4. Listen to ONE song (loud, with headphones)
5. Count backwards from 100 by 7s
6. Cold water on wrists and face
7. Text a friend about something totally different
8. Draw your anger (abstract scribbles count)
9. Write down everything you want to say (don't send)
10. Do 20 push-ups or wall sits
11. Name 5 things you can see, 4 hear, 3 touch, 2 smell, 1 taste
12. Rip up paper into tiny pieces
13. Put in earbuds and listen to a guided meditation (even 2 min)
14. Go outside - just stand outside for 2 minutes
15. Squeeze a stress ball until your hand is tired
16. Watch a funny video (have one saved for emergencies)
17. Chew gum aggressively
18. Take a shower (water resets your nervous system)
19. Journal stream-of-consciousness for 5 minutes
20. Play a simple phone game (Tetris, puzzle) for 5 min

MY TOP 5 GO-TO STRATEGIES:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____

THOUGHT CHALLENGE #1

SITUATION: Someone posts something mean about you online

HOT THOUGHT: "Everyone is laughing at me. I'll destroy them."

What emotion am I actually feeling under the anger?

Is my hot thought 100% true? What's the evidence?

What's another way to see this situation?

What would my best friend say to me right now?

Will this matter in 1 week? 1 month? 1 year?

1 week: _____ 1 month: _____ 1 year: _____

What's a more balanced thought I can replace the hot thought with?

What's the SMART move here (not the anger move)?

Anger level BEFORE this exercise: ____/10

Anger level AFTER this exercise: ____/10

THOUGHT CHALLENGE #2

SITUATION: Your parent says you can't go out with friends

HOT THOUGHT: "They don't trust me! They ruin EVERYTHING."

What emotion am I actually feeling under the anger?

Is my hot thought 100% true? What's the evidence?

What's another way to see this situation?

What would my best friend say to me right now?

Will this matter in 1 week? 1 month? 1 year?

1 week: _____ 1 month: _____ 1 year: _____

What's a more balanced thought I can replace the hot thought with?

What's the SMART move here (not the anger move)?

Anger level BEFORE this exercise: ____/10

Anger level AFTER this exercise: ____/10

THOUGHT CHALLENGE #3

SITUATION: A teacher calls you out in front of the class

HOT THOUGHT: "They're trying to humiliate me. I hate them."

What emotion am I actually feeling under the anger?

Is my hot thought 100% true? What's the evidence?

What's another way to see this situation?

What would my best friend say to me right now?

Will this matter in 1 week? 1 month? 1 year?

1 week: _____ 1 month: _____ 1 year: _____

What's a more balanced thought I can replace the hot thought with?

What's the SMART move here (not the anger move)?

Anger level BEFORE this exercise: ____/10

Anger level AFTER this exercise: ____/10

THOUGHT CHALLENGE #4

SITUATION: Your friend cancels plans last minute

HOT THOUGHT: "Nobody actually cares about me. They're fake."

What emotion am I actually feeling under the anger?

Is my hot thought 100% true? What's the evidence?

What's another way to see this situation?

What would my best friend say to me right now?

Will this matter in 1 week? 1 month? 1 year?

1 week: _____ 1 month: _____ 1 year: _____

What's a more balanced thought I can replace the hot thought with?

What's the SMART move here (not the anger move)?

Anger level BEFORE this exercise: ____/10

Anger level AFTER this exercise: ____/10

THOUGHT CHALLENGE #5

SITUATION: Your sibling takes your stuff without asking

HOT THOUGHT: "They have ZERO respect for me. They deserve payback."

What emotion am I actually feeling under the anger?

Is my hot thought 100% true? What's the evidence?

What's another way to see this situation?

What would my best friend say to me right now?

Will this matter in 1 week? 1 month? 1 year?

1 week: _____ 1 month: _____ 1 year: _____

What's a more balanced thought I can replace the hot thought with?

What's the SMART move here (not the anger move)?

Anger level BEFORE this exercise: ____/10

Anger level AFTER this exercise: ____/10

ASSERTIVE vs AGGRESSIVE

AGGRESSIVE = Getting your way by intimidation, yelling, threatening

Result: People fear you, avoid you, don't trust you

PASSIVE = Saying nothing, bottling it up, people-pleasing

Result: Resentment builds, eventually explodes 10x worse

ASSERTIVE = Saying what you need clearly, calmly, respectfully

Result: People respect you, problems get solved, you feel empowered

THE ASSERTIVE FORMULA FOR TEENS:

'I feel [emotion] when [specific thing happens]

because [why it matters to me].

What I need is [specific request].'

EXAMPLES:

Instead of: 'GET OUT OF MY ROOM OR I'LL BREAK YOUR STUFF!'

Try: 'I feel frustrated when you come in without knocking because

I need privacy. Can you please knock first?'

Instead of: 'You're the WORST teacher. This class is stupid.'

Try: 'I'm confused about this assignment. Can I get help

understanding what you expect?'

Instead of: (saying nothing and ghosting a friend who hurt you)

Try: 'I felt hurt when you said that in front of everyone.

Our friendship matters to me. Can we talk about it?'

YOUR TURN - Rewrite an aggressive thing you've said recently:

What I said: _____

Assertive version: _____

CONFLICT WITH A PARENT

The Setup: Your parent says something that feels unfair or controlling.

STEP 1: DON'T RESPOND IN THE MOMENT

Say: 'I need to think about this. Can we talk in 20 minutes?'

(This is NOT disrespectful - it's mature.)

STEP 2: COOL DOWN & FIGURE OUT WHAT YOU ACTUALLY NEED

Under the anger, what do I want? More freedom? To feel trusted?

My real need: _____

STEP 3: START THE CONVO WITH UNDERSTANDING

'I get that you [their concern]. I feel [your feeling] because [why]. Can we find a middle ground where [compromise]?'

STEP 4: PROPOSE A SOLUTION

My proposal: _____

What I'm willing to give: _____

STEP 5: IF THEY SAY NO

Stay calm. Ask: 'What would I need to do to earn this?'

This shows maturity and they WILL notice.

CONFLICT WITH A FRIEND

The Setup: A friend did something that pissed you off.

STEP 1: CHECK YOUR ASSUMPTIONS

Did they do it on purpose? Do I have the full story?

What I assume: _____

What might be true: _____

STEP 2: CHOOSE THE RIGHT TIME

Not over text. Not in front of others. In person, privately.

STEP 3: USE THE FORMULA

'Hey, I need to talk about something. When [thing happened],
I felt [emotion]. I didn't want to just let it build up.'

STEP 4: LISTEN TO THEIR SIDE

They might apologize. They might explain. Let them talk.

STEP 5: DECIDE WHAT YOU NEED

Apology? Changed behavior? Or do you need to set a boundary?

What I need from this convo: _____

CONFLICT WITH A TEACHER

The Setup: A teacher is unfair, embarrasses you, or you disagree.

RULE #1: Never escalate with a teacher publicly. You will lose.

STEP 1: STAY QUIET IN THE MOMENT

Breathe. You can address it later. Reacting now = consequences.

STEP 2: TALK PRIVATELY AFTER CLASS

'Can I talk to you for a minute? I felt [emotion] when [thing].

I want to understand / I want to explain my perspective.'

STEP 3: STAY RESPECTFUL EVEN IF THEY'RE WRONG

Teachers are human. They make mistakes. Giving them grace = they'll give you grace back.

STEP 4: IF IT DOESN'T RESOLVE

Talk to a counselor, parent, or another trusted adult.

Document what happened (date, time, what was said).

STEP 5: WHAT I'LL DO NEXT TIME

My plan: _____

CONFLICT WITH A SIBLING

The Setup: Your sibling is annoying, takes your stuff, starts drama.

REALITY CHECK: You live together. You have to coexist.

STEP 1: IS THIS WORTH MY ENERGY?

Scale of 1-10, how much does this actually matter? ____

If under 5: Let it go. Save your energy for real battles.

STEP 2: SET A CLEAR BOUNDARY

'Don't touch my [thing]. If you need to borrow something, ask.'

Keep it simple. Don't lecture.

STEP 3: DON'T TAKE THE BAIT

Siblings know your buttons because they installed them.

When they poke: grey rock (boring, short answers, walk away).

STEP 4: INVOLVE PARENTS STRATEGICALLY

Only for real issues. Tattling about everything = lose credibility.

STEP 5: WHAT BOUNDARY WILL I SET?

My boundary: _____

Consequence if crossed: _____

CONFLICT ON SOCIAL MEDIA

The Setup: Someone posts about you, starts drama online, cyberbullying.

RULE #1: NEVER respond in anger online. Screenshots last forever.

STEP 1: PUT THE PHONE DOWN

Literally set a timer: 1 hour. Do NOT respond for 1 hour.

STEP 2: ASK YOURSELF

Is this person worth my peace? ____

Will responding make it better or worse? ____

What do I actually gain by clapping back? ____

STEP 3: YOUR OPTIONS

- a) Ignore completely (this drives them CRAZY)
- b) Block/mute (not weakness - it's power)
- c) Screenshot and report (if it's harassment)
- d) Talk to a trusted adult (if it's serious)

STEP 4: NEVER DO THIS

- Don't screenshot and share to 'expose' them
- Don't get your friends to gang up on them
- Don't make vague posts about them

These ALL escalate and make YOU look bad.

STEP 5: My plan for next online conflict:

I will: _____

CONSEQUENCE THINKING

Think it through BEFORE you act

When anger takes over, we stop thinking about consequences.
Practice this BEFORE you're angry so it becomes automatic:

SITUATION 1: _____

What I WANT to do (anger response): _____

Consequences in 5 MINUTES: _____

Consequences in 5 DAYS: _____

Consequences in 5 MONTHS: _____

Is it worth it? YES / NO

SMART alternative action: _____

SITUATION 2: _____

What I WANT to do (anger response): _____

Consequences in 5 MINUTES: _____

Consequences in 5 DAYS: _____

Consequences in 5 MONTHS: _____

Is it worth it? YES / NO

SMART alternative action: _____

SITUATION 3: _____

What I WANT to do (anger response): _____

Consequences in 5 MINUTES: _____

Consequences in 5 DAYS: _____

Consequences in 5 MONTHS: _____

Is it worth it? YES / NO

SMART alternative action: _____

SITUATION 4: _____

What I WANT to do (anger response): _____

Consequences in 5 MINUTES: _____

Consequences in 5 DAYS: _____

Consequences in 5 MONTHS: _____

Is it worth it? YES / NO

SMART alternative action: _____

WEEKLY ANGER LOG - WEEK 1

Day 1 Date: ___/___/___

Trigger: _____ Level (1-5): ____

Strategy used: _____ Did it work? Y/N

What I'd do differently: _____

Day 2 Date: ___/___/___

Trigger: _____ Level (1-5): ____

Strategy used: _____ Did it work? Y/N

What I'd do differently: _____

Day 3 Date: ___/___/___

Trigger: _____ Level (1-5): ____

Strategy used: _____ Did it work? Y/N

What I'd do differently: _____

Day 4 Date: ___/___/___

Trigger: _____ Level (1-5): ____

Strategy used: _____ Did it work? Y/N

What I'd do differently: _____

Day 5 Date: ___/___/___

Trigger: _____ Level (1-5): ____

Strategy used: _____ Did it work? Y/N

What I'd do differently: _____

Day 6 Date: ___/___/___

Trigger: _____ Level (1-5): ____

Strategy used: _____ Did it work? Y/N

What I'd do differently: _____

Day 7 Date: ___/___/___

Trigger: _____ Level (1-5): ____

Strategy used: _____ Did it work? Y/N

What I'd do differently: _____

WEEKLY ANGER LOG - WEEK 2

Day 1 Date: ___/___/___

Trigger: _____ Level (1-5): ____

Strategy used: _____ Did it work? Y/N

What I'd do differently: _____

Day 2 Date: ___/___/___

Trigger: _____ Level (1-5): ____

Strategy used: _____ Did it work? Y/N

What I'd do differently: _____

Day 3 Date: ___/___/___

Trigger: _____ Level (1-5): ____

Strategy used: _____ Did it work? Y/N

What I'd do differently: _____

Day 4 Date: ___/___/___

Trigger: _____ Level (1-5): ____

Strategy used: _____ Did it work? Y/N

What I'd do differently: _____

Day 5 Date: ___/___/___

Trigger: _____ Level (1-5): ____

Strategy used: _____ Did it work? Y/N

What I'd do differently: _____

Day 6 Date: ___/___/___

Trigger: _____ Level (1-5): ____

Strategy used: _____ Did it work? Y/N

What I'd do differently: _____

Day 7 Date: ___/___/___

Trigger: _____ Level (1-5): ____

Strategy used: _____ Did it work? Y/N

What I'd do differently: _____

WEEKLY ANGER LOG - WEEK 3

Day 1 Date: ____/____/____

Trigger: _____ Level (1-5): ____

Strategy used: _____ Did it work? Y/N

What I'd do differently: _____

Day 2 Date: ____/____/____

Trigger: _____ Level (1-5): ____

Strategy used: _____ Did it work? Y/N

What I'd do differently: _____

Day 3 Date: ____/____/____

Trigger: _____ Level (1-5): ____

Strategy used: _____ Did it work? Y/N

What I'd do differently: _____

Day 4 Date: ____/____/____

Trigger: _____ Level (1-5): ____

Strategy used: _____ Did it work? Y/N

What I'd do differently: _____

Day 5 Date: ____/____/____

Trigger: _____ Level (1-5): ____

Strategy used: _____ Did it work? Y/N

What I'd do differently: _____

Day 6 Date: ____/____/____

Trigger: _____ Level (1-5): ____

Strategy used: _____ Did it work? Y/N

What I'd do differently: _____

Day 7 Date: ____/____/____

Trigger: _____ Level (1-5): ____

Strategy used: _____ Did it work? Y/N

What I'd do differently: _____

WEEKLY ANGER LOG - WEEK 4

Day 1 Date: ___/___/___

Trigger: _____ Level (1-5): ____

Strategy used: _____ Did it work? Y/N

What I'd do differently: _____

Day 2 Date: ___/___/___

Trigger: _____ Level (1-5): ____

Strategy used: _____ Did it work? Y/N

What I'd do differently: _____

Day 3 Date: ___/___/___

Trigger: _____ Level (1-5): ____

Strategy used: _____ Did it work? Y/N

What I'd do differently: _____

Day 4 Date: ___/___/___

Trigger: _____ Level (1-5): ____

Strategy used: _____ Did it work? Y/N

What I'd do differently: _____

Day 5 Date: ___/___/___

Trigger: _____ Level (1-5): ____

Strategy used: _____ Did it work? Y/N

What I'd do differently: _____

Day 6 Date: ___/___/___

Trigger: _____ Level (1-5): ____

Strategy used: _____ Did it work? Y/N

What I'd do differently: _____

Day 7 Date: ___/___/___

Trigger: _____ Level (1-5): ____

Strategy used: _____ Did it work? Y/N

What I'd do differently: _____

WEEKLY ANGER LOG - WEEK 5

Day 1 Date: ___/___/___

Trigger: _____ Level (1-5): ____

Strategy used: _____ Did it work? Y/N

What I'd do differently: _____

Day 2 Date: ___/___/___

Trigger: _____ Level (1-5): ____

Strategy used: _____ Did it work? Y/N

What I'd do differently: _____

Day 3 Date: ___/___/___

Trigger: _____ Level (1-5): ____

Strategy used: _____ Did it work? Y/N

What I'd do differently: _____

Day 4 Date: ___/___/___

Trigger: _____ Level (1-5): ____

Strategy used: _____ Did it work? Y/N

What I'd do differently: _____

Day 5 Date: ___/___/___

Trigger: _____ Level (1-5): ____

Strategy used: _____ Did it work? Y/N

What I'd do differently: _____

Day 6 Date: ___/___/___

Trigger: _____ Level (1-5): ____

Strategy used: _____ Did it work? Y/N

What I'd do differently: _____

Day 7 Date: ___/___/___

Trigger: _____ Level (1-5): ____

Strategy used: _____ Did it work? Y/N

What I'd do differently: _____

WEEKLY ANGER LOG - WEEK 6

Day 1 Date: ___/___/___

Trigger: _____ Level (1-5): ____

Strategy used: _____ Did it work? Y/N

What I'd do differently: _____

Day 2 Date: ___/___/___

Trigger: _____ Level (1-5): ____

Strategy used: _____ Did it work? Y/N

What I'd do differently: _____

Day 3 Date: ___/___/___

Trigger: _____ Level (1-5): ____

Strategy used: _____ Did it work? Y/N

What I'd do differently: _____

Day 4 Date: ___/___/___

Trigger: _____ Level (1-5): ____

Strategy used: _____ Did it work? Y/N

What I'd do differently: _____

Day 5 Date: ___/___/___

Trigger: _____ Level (1-5): ____

Strategy used: _____ Did it work? Y/N

What I'd do differently: _____

Day 6 Date: ___/___/___

Trigger: _____ Level (1-5): ____

Strategy used: _____ Did it work? Y/N

What I'd do differently: _____

Day 7 Date: ___/___/___

Trigger: _____ Level (1-5): ____

Strategy used: _____ Did it work? Y/N

What I'd do differently: _____

WEEKLY ANGER LOG - WEEK 7

Day 1 Date: ___/___/___

Trigger: _____ Level (1-5): ____

Strategy used: _____ Did it work? Y/N

What I'd do differently: _____

Day 2 Date: ___/___/___

Trigger: _____ Level (1-5): ____

Strategy used: _____ Did it work? Y/N

What I'd do differently: _____

Day 3 Date: ___/___/___

Trigger: _____ Level (1-5): ____

Strategy used: _____ Did it work? Y/N

What I'd do differently: _____

Day 4 Date: ___/___/___

Trigger: _____ Level (1-5): ____

Strategy used: _____ Did it work? Y/N

What I'd do differently: _____

Day 5 Date: ___/___/___

Trigger: _____ Level (1-5): ____

Strategy used: _____ Did it work? Y/N

What I'd do differently: _____

Day 6 Date: ___/___/___

Trigger: _____ Level (1-5): ____

Strategy used: _____ Did it work? Y/N

What I'd do differently: _____

Day 7 Date: ___/___/___

Trigger: _____ Level (1-5): ____

Strategy used: _____ Did it work? Y/N

What I'd do differently: _____

WEEKLY ANGER LOG - WEEK 8

Day 1 Date: __/__/__

Trigger: _____ Level (1-5): ____

Strategy used: _____ Did it work? Y/N

What I'd do differently: _____

Day 2 Date: __/__/__

Trigger: _____ Level (1-5): ____

Strategy used: _____ Did it work? Y/N

What I'd do differently: _____

Day 3 Date: __/__/__

Trigger: _____ Level (1-5): ____

Strategy used: _____ Did it work? Y/N

What I'd do differently: _____

Day 4 Date: __/__/__

Trigger: _____ Level (1-5): ____

Strategy used: _____ Did it work? Y/N

What I'd do differently: _____

Day 5 Date: __/__/__

Trigger: _____ Level (1-5): ____

Strategy used: _____ Did it work? Y/N

What I'd do differently: _____

Day 6 Date: __/__/__

Trigger: _____ Level (1-5): ____

Strategy used: _____ Did it work? Y/N

What I'd do differently: _____

Day 7 Date: __/__/__

Trigger: _____ Level (1-5): ____

Strategy used: _____ Did it work? Y/N

What I'd do differently: _____

MY ANGER ACTION PLAN

MY TOP 3 TRIGGERS:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

MY EARLY WARNING SIGN (the first one I notice):

MY GO-TO COOL-DOWN STRATEGIES:

At school: _____

At home: _____

Online: _____

MY ASSERTIVE PHRASE (memorize this):

'I feel _____ when _____ because _____.

What I need is _____.'

MY SUPPORT PEOPLE:

Person I can talk to: _____

Person I can text when I'm heated: _____

WHEN I MESS UP (because I will sometimes):

1. Don't beat myself up - I'm learning
2. Apologize if I hurt someone (no excuses, just sorry)
3. Figure out what went wrong
4. Try again tomorrow

MY GOAL: I want to get to the point where I can:

LETTER OF APOLOGY TEMPLATE

For when you mess up (we all do)

A REAL apology has 5 parts:

1. NAME what you did (no minimizing)

'I [specific thing I did]...'

2. ACKNOWLEDGE how it affected them

'I know that made you feel [emotion]...'

3. TAKE RESPONSIBILITY (no 'but')

'That was wrong of me. There's no excuse.'

4. SAY WHAT YOU'LL DO DIFFERENTLY

'Next time, I will [specific different action]...'

5. ASK if there's anything else they need

'Is there anything else I can do to make this right?'

MY APOLOGY (draft it here first):

Remember: An apology without changed behavior is just manipulation.

YOU'VE GOT THIS

The fact that you're reading this workbook means you WANT to change.
That takes guts. Most people just keep exploding and blaming everyone else.

Remember:

- Anger is normal. How you handle it is what matters.
- Every time you choose a strategy over a blowup, you're rewiring your brain.
- Progress isn't perfect. It's doing better more often than not.
- You deserve relationships where people feel safe around you.
- You deserve to feel in control of yourself.

If you need more help:

- Talk to a school counselor (it's free and confidential)
- 988 Suicide & Crisis Lifeline (call or text 988)
- Crisis Text Line (text HOME to 741741)
- Ask a parent/guardian about therapy (it's not just for 'crazy' people)

You are not your worst moment.

You are the person choosing to do better.